
HPL *ink* Music

User manual

A detailed guide to library indexing, artwork, playback, EQ visualization, Chromecast, Internet radio and audio output selection.

Application version

v1.50 dated 12 July 2026

Platform

Windows x64, WinUI 3

Distribution

portable, self-contained

Manual scope: this document describes `HPL ink Music v 1.50 [12.07.2026]`. Items marked **INTERNET** need a network connection, while **OPTIONAL** components are only required in specific scenarios.

English user manual

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1. Version and purpose

Item	Information
Full name	HPL ink Music v 1.50 [12.07.2026]
Main purpose	Build a local music index, find recordings and play files without moving them from their existing folders.
Additional features	Metadata, covers, EQ visualization, Chromecast, Internet radio, audio output selection and a PL/EN interface.
Installation model	Portable. The complete application folder is required and the application stores its databases next to the EXE.

Important: the index contains information about the audio files; it is not a copy of the music. Re-index after moving or deleting recordings outside the application.

2. Requirements and startup

Requirements

- Windows 10 version 2004 (build 19041) or newer; Windows 11 and a 64-bit system are recommended.
- The complete application directory. Do not copy and run `HPLMusicWinUI.exe` without its libraries, `Assets` folder and FFmpeg tools.
- Write access to the application folder for the index, settings, radio stations and covers.

- Internet access only for online covers, radio and Chromecast. **INTERNET**

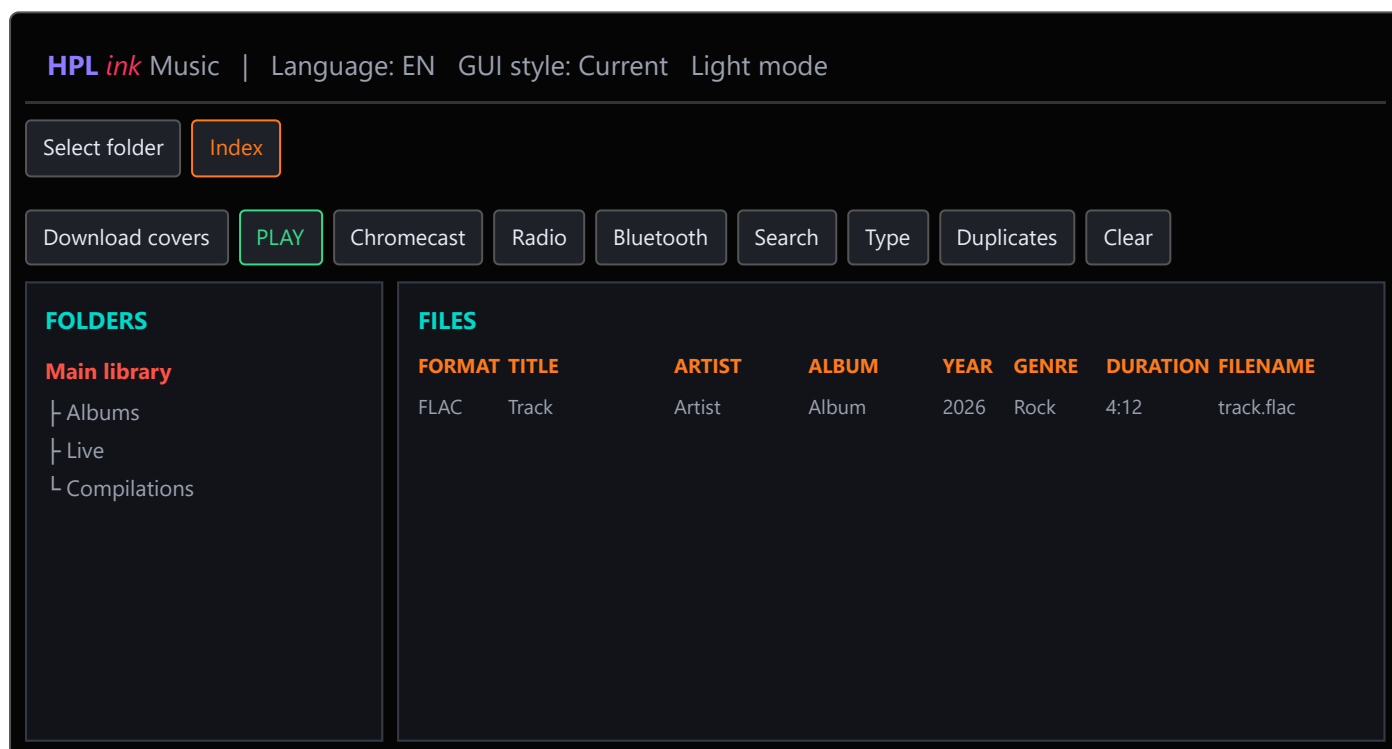
First run

1. Extract the complete application folder.
2. Run `HPLMusicWinUI.exe`.
3. On the first run, select a music folder and index it.
4. On later runs, an existing `hpl_music_index.sqlite` is loaded automatically.

Computer authorization: a licensed build may enforce MAC-address authorization. If the application reports that the computer is not authorized, contact the application supplier.

3. Main window

The diagram below shows the layout without private paths or filenames.



Window bands

- **Top bar:** PL/EN language, GUI style, light/dark switch and logo.
- **Folder bar:** library path, folder picker and **Index**.
- **Tool bar:** covers, playback, Chromecast, radio, Bluetooth, search, type filter, duplicates and filter reset.
- **Left:** folder tree with counts. **Right:** recording table.
- **Bottom:** status, indexing progress and the double-click hint.

4. Indexing the library

1. Select folder

Choose the parent folder that contains the music.

2. Index

The application scans it and every subfolder.

3. Wait

Status shows the processed and total file counts.

4. Select a branch

Click a folder in the tree to display recordings.

Indexing reads title, artist, album, year, genre, duration, format, size and path. Inaccessible folders are skipped instead of stopping the full scan. The result is saved in a local SQLite database.

Extensions included in a scan

.aac .ac3 .aiff .dts .flac .m4a .mp3 .ogg .opus .wav .wma

Good practice: re-index after adding, removing, moving or renaming a significant number of files.

5. Browsing, searching and organizing

Folders and table

Click a folder in the left tree. The right-hand list shows files from that branch and its subfolders. Click **Format**, **Title**, **Artist**, **Album**, **Year**, **Genre**, **Duration** or **Filename** to sort; click the same header again to reverse the order.

Search

1. Enter one or more terms.
2. Press or click **Search**.
3. Every term must occur in the file data. The search covers title, artist, album, year, genre, filename, folder and full path.
4. Optionally select an extension in **Type**. The type filter works alone or together with text.

Duplicates

Duplicates lists files with the same filename and the same size. The application never deletes them automatically. Compare the paths and remove an unwanted copy in Windows File Explorer.

Clear removes search text, the type filter and result mode, then restores the library tree.

6. Editing metadata

1. Right-click a file.
2. Select **Edit metadata**.
3. Edit the title, artist, album, year or genre.
4. Click **Save**.

Caution: saving changes the tags in the original audio file. Back up important files before bulk editing. Some formats or file variants do not support reliable tag writing; the application then displays an error.

7. Downloading covers

INTERNET FOR SOURCE 2

1. Click **Download covers**.
2. Select an indexed folder.
3. Choose a source:
 - **Source 1: from files** reads artwork embedded in audio tags.
 - **Source 2: online for missing** searches MusicBrainz and downloads artwork from Cover Art Archive.
4. Wait for the found, skipped, missing and error summary.

Existing assignments are skipped. Images are saved in `hpl_music_covers` and mappings in `hpl_music_covers.sqlite`. An orange dot in the player means a real cover was found; no dot means the fallback image is shown.

8. Player

Starting playback

1. Select a folder or search result set.
2. Select a recording.
3. Click the green **PLAY** button or double-click the row.

The visible list becomes the player playlist and the selected file becomes its starting item. The main window is hidden; **Show GUI** brings it back without closing the player.

Control	Action
Previous / Next	Moves through the current playlist and wraps at either end.
Play / Pause	Starts, pauses or resumes standard formats.
Stop	Stops playback and resets the position.
Progress slider	Seeks when duration is known and the active engine supports seeking.
Volume / Mute	Controls output level; Mute is available in mini mode.
Show/Hide playlist	Resizes the window. Double-click an item to play it immediately.
Always on top	Keeps the full player above other windows.

AC3 and DTS **FFPLAY**

`.ac3` and `.dts` are played through `ffplay.exe`. Duration may remain at `0:00`, seeking and conventional pause are unavailable, and Play acts as stop/restart. When playback ends naturally, the player advances to the next item.

9. Equalizer and mini mode

Visualizer types

Choose **Bars**, **Neon LED reflection**, **Rainbow segments** or **Soundwave neon**. The color can be multicolor or a single purple, light purple, neon red, turquoise, cyan, blue, green, yellow, orange or white.

The selection is saved and used in full and mini player views. Radio keeps its own independent EQ type and color.

Mini mode

Click **Minimize** for a wide compact panel with track information, controls, artwork and EQ. Click **GUI** to restore the full player. Closing the player stops music and reopens the main window.

10. Chromecast LOCAL NETWORK

1. Connect the computer and Chromecast to the same network.
2. Click **Chromecast**; discovery takes several seconds.
3. If several receivers are found, choose one and confirm.
4. After the connection message, select a file and use the normal **PLAY** button.

MP3, WAV, FLAC, AAC and M4A are served directly. Other supported formats are transcoded to MP3 by the local `ffmpeg.exe`. The application starts a temporary HTTP server, so Windows Firewall may ask for private-network access.

Important: keep both the application and computer running. Guest Wi-Fi, client isolation, VPN or firewall rules can prevent discovery or block the stream.

The player supports pause, resume, seek, volume and automatic next-track behavior. Click **Disconnect Cast** in the main window to end the session.

11. Internet radio

INTERNET

Playback

1. Click **Radio**.
2. Select a station.
3. Click Play or double-click the row.
4. Adjust volume and EQ independently from file playback.

When no user database exists, the application provides starter stations. Search filters name, country, genre and URL; the genre list narrows the result. A station may link to audio directly or to an M3U, M3U8 or PLS playlist; the application attempts to resolve its first stream URL.

Add and edit

Add station and **Edit** provide name, stream URL, country, genre and logo URL fields. Name and URL are required. **Delete** asks for confirmation and saves the change.

M3U import and export

- **Load M3U** accepts `.m3u` and `.m3u8`. Entries with URLs already stored are skipped.
- **Export M3U** saves the currently visible stations. If a filter is active, only that filtered set is exported.

Mini view and playlist

Minimize switches radio to a wide mini panel. **Hide/Show playlist** works in both views. Closing the radio window stops the stream.

12. Bluetooth and audio output

Bluetooth chooses the output device for both player and radio. It does not pair Bluetooth hardware.

1. If the device is not paired, click **Open Windows BT settings** and pair it in Windows.
2. Return and click **Refresh**.
3. Select the device or **Windows default device**.
4. Click **Set as active** or double-click the row.

The choice is saved and applied immediately to an open player and radio. If the device disappears, select the Windows default output and refresh the list.

13. Language, theme and GUI style

Option	Action
PL / EN language	Changes labels in the main window, player, radio and Bluetooth window. The choice is saved.
GUI style: Current	Classic application appearance. The main window offers a light/dark switch.
GUI style: Black Glass	Forces the dark glass variant in all windows. The light/dark button is disabled in this style.

14. Program files and supported formats

File or folder	Purpose
hpl_music_index.sqlite	Library index and remembered root path.
hpl_music_settings.json	Language, appearance, EQ and selected audio output.
hpl_music_covers.sqlite	File-to-cover mappings.
hpl_music_covers	Local cover image cache.
hpl_music_radio.json	User radio stations.
hpl_music_winui_crash.log	Last unhandled crash report, if one occurred.
ffplay.exe	AC3/DTS playback.
ffmpeg.exe	Chromecast transcoding.
Assets	Application icon and artwork.

Backup: copy the full application directory, or at least the data files above and the cover cache, to preserve settings, radio, covers and index.

15. Quick operations

Operation	Result
Enter in search	Runs the search.
Double-click a file	Plays the selected recording.
Right-click a file	Opens metadata editing.
Click a table header	Sorts ascending; click again for descending.
Double-click a playlist item	Switches to that track or station.
Double-click an audio device	Sets it as active.

16. Troubleshooting

The list is empty after startup

Select a valid folder and click **Index**. After completion, click a folder in the left tree. Loading an index intentionally leaves the file table empty until a folder or search result is selected.

The index or settings are not saved

Data is stored next to the EXE. Move the complete directory to a user-writable location outside `Program Files`, then index again. Do not run a copied EXE on its own.

A file is missing

Check that its extension is supported and re-index. A folder without access permission may have been skipped.

No online cover is found

Correct the artist, album or title, check the Internet connection and retry. Not every release has artwork in MusicBrainz/Cover Art Archive.

AC3 or DTS does not play

Ensure `ffmpeg.exe` is in the application folder. The program can also search PATH and several common locations, but the local copy is recommended.

Chromecast is not found or does not play

Check the shared network, disable client isolation and VPN, allow private-network access in Windows Firewall, and ensure `ffmpeg.exe` exists for formats that need transcoding.

Radio does not play

Check Internet access and the station URL. The provider may have changed or blocked the stream. Test another station, then edit or delete the broken entry.

A Bluetooth device is missing

Pair and power on the device in Windows, click **Refresh**, and choose its audio profile. The application does not pair devices itself.

The application closed after an error

Check `hpl_music_winui_crash.log` in the application directory and provide it to support with a description of the last action.